

LCB TRAINING

COLLEGE BASEBALL RECRUITING GUIDE

Everything You Need to Know to Get Recruited

A complete guide for high school baseball players and their families on navigating the college recruiting process at every level.

All High School Ages | D1, D2, D3, JUCO, NAIA | Coach Broc Approved

A Note from Coach Broc

The college recruiting process is one of the most exciting and overwhelming experiences a young athlete and their family can go through. There is a lot of misinformation out there, a lot of pressure, and a lot of decisions that can feel bigger than they are.

Here is the truth: there is a college program for every committed, coachable player who wants to keep playing. D1 is not the only path. JUCO changed my life. D3 produces professional players. NAIA programs offer full rides. Your job is not to chase a logo — it is to find the right fit and put yourself in a position to be seen.

This guide gives you a clear roadmap for every year of high school so you never feel behind and always know what your next move is.

"There is a place for every player who works hard enough to earn it."

Section 1 — Understanding the College Levels

One of the biggest mistakes families make is fixating on one division without understanding what all the options look like. Here is a clear breakdown of every level of college baseball:

Division	Programs	Scholarships	What to Know
NCAA D1	300+ programs	Up to 11.7 per team	Highest level of college baseball. Most competitive. Scholarships are partial — split among many players. Requires elite performance and early recruiting.
NCAA D2	270+ programs	Up to 9.0 per team	Highly competitive with more scholarship money per player on average. Great academics and baseball balance. Underrated by many families.
NCAA D3	380+ programs	No athletic scholarships	Most programs in college baseball. No athletic aid but strong academic and need-based aid available. Many D3 players go on to play professionally.
JUCO	500+ programs	Varies by program	Junior college baseball. Two-year programs. Can be a launching pad to D1. Coach Broc attended Oakton CC and won a national championship. Life-changing opportunity.
NAIA	170+ programs	Up to 24 per team	Most scholarship money per player of any division. Smaller schools, strong communities. Often overlooked but extremely valuable path for the right player.

The Truth About College Levels

- JUCO is not a backup plan — it is a strategy. Many D1 players started at JUCO.
- D3 schools cannot offer athletic scholarships but they can offer significant academic aid.
- NAIA programs often have the most scholarship money available per player.
- The right fit — academically, athletically, and personally — matters more than the division.
- Do not eliminate a level without researching it. Your goal is to play college baseball, not chase a logo.

Section 2 — Year-by-Year Recruiting Timeline

Recruiting rewards the prepared. Here is exactly what you should be doing each year of high school to stay ahead of the process and put yourself in the best position to be recruited.

Year	Priority Actions
Freshman Year	Focus on grades — GPA matters as much as batting average to college coaches. Play as much as possible. Get exposure at tournaments and showcases. Create an email account dedicated to recruiting. Begin a list of schools you are interested in. Start building your athletic resume.
Sophomore Year	Start reaching out to college coaches via email with a short introduction and your stats. Attend camps at schools you are interested in — coaches are watching. Get your first highlight video made. Take the PSAT. Research academic requirements for programs on your list. Begin narrowing your school list to 20-30 realistic targets across multiple divisions.
Junior Year	Most important recruiting year. Take the SAT/ACT. Register on NCAA Eligibility Center (ncaa.org). Send your highlight video to every school on your list. Follow up with coaches who respond. Take official and unofficial visits. Attend elite showcases and tournaments where college coaches scout. Narrow your list to 10-15 schools and pursue them aggressively.
Senior Year	Sign a National Letter of Intent (NLI) during the early signing period if you have a commitment. If still looking, keep reaching out — coaches have roster spots to fill all year. Do not overlook late opportunities — JUCO, D3, and NAIA programs recruit year-round. Stay focused on your senior season — coaches watch how you compete even after committing.

Section 3 — Your Highlight Video

Your highlight video is your first impression with most college coaches. It needs to be short, professional, and show your best moments clearly. A bad highlight video can hurt you. A great one can open doors.

Highlight Video Must-Knows

- Keep it 3-5 minutes maximum. Coaches will stop watching after that.
- Put your absolute best clips in the first 60 seconds — that is all some coaches will watch.
- Include game footage, not just practice or tee work.
- Show your defense AND your offense if you are a position player.
- Include your measurables on screen at the start: name, grad year, position, height, weight, GPA.
- Use simple editing — clean cuts, no flashy transitions or loud music that distracts from the baseball.

- Upload to YouTube as unlisted and include the link in every email to coaches.
- Update your video every season with new footage.

Section 4 — How to Email College Coaches

Most recruiting relationships start with an email. Coaches receive hundreds of emails — yours needs to be professional, concise, and make it easy for them to evaluate you quickly.

What to Include in Your First Email:

- Subject line: "Prospective Student-Athlete — [Position] — Class of [Year] — [Your Name]"
- Short intro: who you are, your position, graduation year, GPA
- Why you are interested in their specific program — do your research, be genuine
- Your stats from your most recent season
- Your highlight video link (YouTube)
- Your schedule of upcoming tournaments or showcases where they can see you play
- Your contact information and your parents' contact information

Emailing Coaches — Best Practices

- Keep the email under 200 words. Coaches are busy — respect their time.
- Personalize every email. Do not send a mass generic email — coaches can tell.
- Follow up after 2 weeks if you do not hear back. One follow up is appropriate.
- Always be professional — no slang, no emojis, check your spelling.
- CC your parents so coaches know who to contact for next steps.
- Keep a spreadsheet tracking every school you emailed and their responses.

Section 5 — Showcases, Camps & Visits

Showcases

Showcases are events where college coaches come specifically to evaluate players. They are one of the best ways to get seen by multiple programs at once. Research which showcases the coaches from your target schools attend before registering.

- Perfect Game, PG Showcases — widely attended by coaches at all levels
- Area Code Games — invitation only, elite level
- WWBA — one of the most heavily scouted tournaments in the country
- Regional showcases — often overlooked but coaches from local programs attend heavily

College Camps

Attending a camp at a school you are interested in is one of the most underrated recruiting tools. Coaches see you in person, evaluate your coachability, and get a sense of your character — things a highlight video can never show. If you are serious about a school, attend their camp.

Official vs Unofficial Visits

Official Visit

Paid for by the school. Can only happen after September 1 of junior year for D1. Limited to 5 official visits total. This is a serious step — it means the coach is very interested.

Unofficial Visit

You pay for the trip. Can happen at any time. Great way to see the campus, meet the coaches, and show your interest in the program.

Section 6 — Academics & Eligibility

No matter how good you are on the field, you cannot play college baseball if you do not meet the academic requirements. This is non-negotiable. Start taking academics seriously freshman year.

Academic Checklist

- o Register on the NCAA Eligibility Center at eligibilitycenter.org (do this by junior year)
- o Take 16 core courses in the NCAA-required subjects throughout high school
- o Achieve a minimum GPA in your core courses (varies by division and test score)
- o Take the SAT or ACT by the end of junior year — give yourself time to retake if needed
- o Keep your social media clean — coaches and compliance departments check
- o Do not take shortcuts — eligibility issues can disqualify you entirely

- o For JUCO: academic requirements are more flexible — ask each program directly
- o For D3 and NAIA: contact schools directly for their specific academic requirements

Section 7 — Making Your Decision

When offers come in, the decision can feel overwhelming. Here is a framework for choosing the right program — not just the most impressive name.

Will you play?

Sitting the bench at a D1 school is not better than starting at D3. Ask the coach honestly where you fit in their plans.

Do you like the coaches?

You will spend 4 years with these people. Your relationship with the coaching staff matters enormously.

Can you afford it?

Understand the full financial picture — tuition, room, board, scholarship amount, academic aid. Get everything in writing.

Does the school fit you academically?

You are going to college first and playing baseball second. Make sure the academics work for your future career.

Does it feel right?

Trust your gut when you visit. If it does not feel like home, keep looking.

"The best program is not the one with the best logo. It is the one where you will grow the most as a player and a person."

Want Coach Broc to review your recruiting profile?

Elite members get personal feedback on their recruiting profile and highlight reel. Sign up at lcbtraining.com to get started.

lcbtraining.com